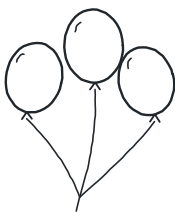


What's really holding this situation in place?



Six Conditions of Systems Change, after Kania, Kramer & Senge, FSG.

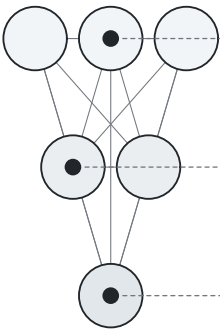
Any stuck pattern is held in place by six things, tied together like balloons on elastic. Pull one and the others move. It works best with a few people, so you get some healthy disagreement.

THREE STEPS

- 1 Write the problem at the top of the sheet.
- 2 Put each thing you notice in the balloon it fits, one sticky note each. Start at the top row, then keep going down. The lower rows are harder to see, and matter more.
- 3 Find the tightest elastic. What, if it moved, would pull the others with it?

FOR EXAMPLE

A sports club that keeps losing its teenagers.



"Training clashes with exam season."

top row: practices

"Older players don't really talk to the younger ones."

middle row: relationships

"We all assume kids just lose interest at that age."

bottom row: mental models

The tightest elastic might be the bottom note. If the club stopped believing kids just drift off, the other two start to look fixable.

THEN TALK ABOUT IT

What did doing this stir in us?

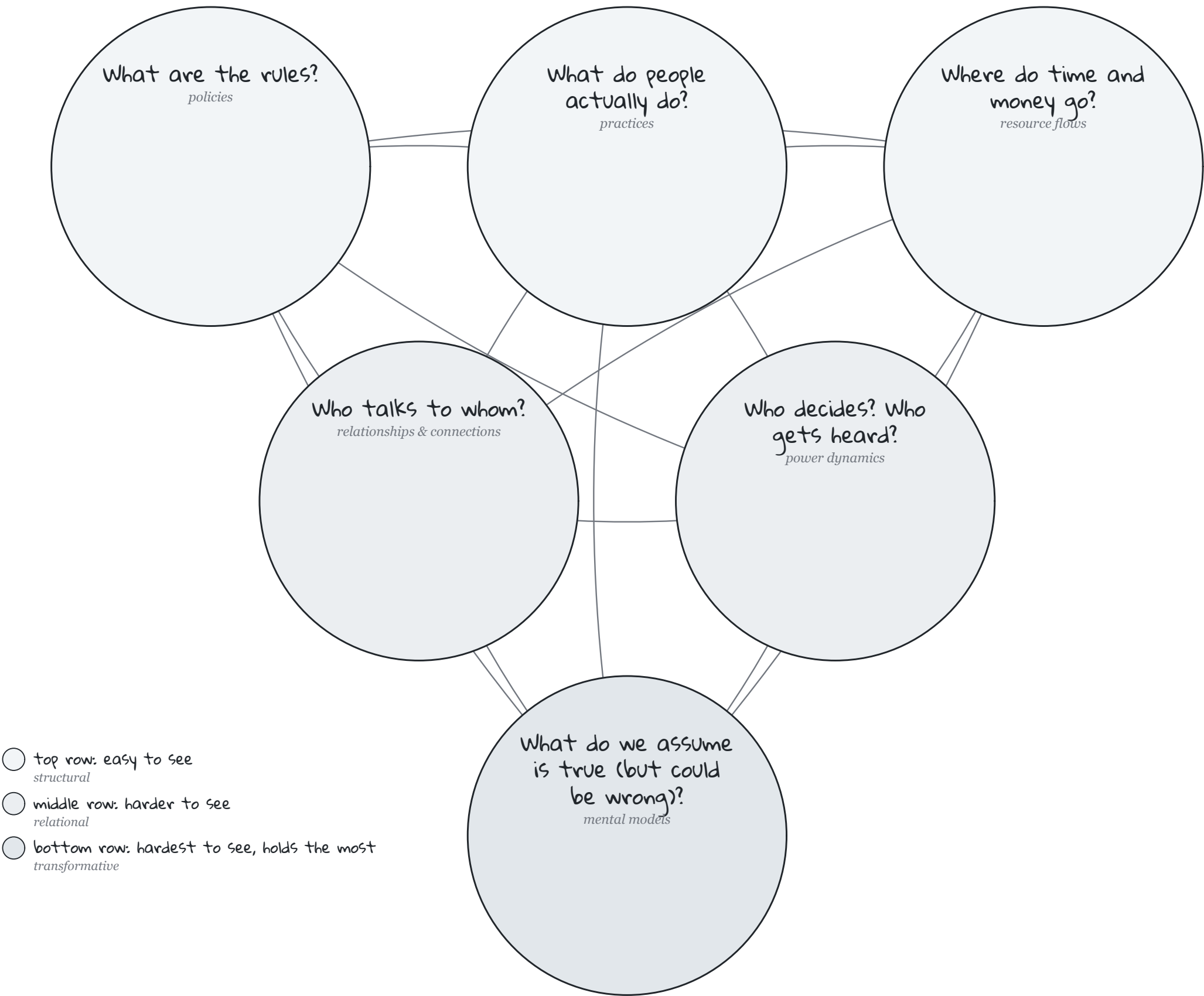
The feelings that come up are signs too. Before you move on, talk about them.

GOING FURTHER

Use it more than once. Map things before you start. When something pushes back, ask which balloon it's pulling on. At the end, lay a new map beside your first one (keep a photo). What moved, and what held?

Watch for staying on the top row. It's the easiest to talk about, and on its own it seldom shifts much.

THE PROBLEM WE'RE LOOKING AT



- top row: easy to see
structural
- middle row: harder to see
relational
- bottom row: hardest to see, holds the most
transformative